

Written Status Report CMSI 4072

Project Status Sheet Spring 2026

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Project: Sammy's Games: A Board and Card Game Platform

Date: April 22, 2026

Period Covered: April 9 – April 22

Accomplishments since last report: Following up on my goal to make a more unique third game entry, I actually developed two brand new games: **Color Spiral** and **Step Count**. Both games heavily rely on grid-based mechanics and allowed me to creatively expand upon the BFS/flood-fill logic I originally built for Five/Six Hands. Specific technical milestones include:

- **Step Count Implementation:** Built a 2-player strategy game on a 7x7 grid where players move a specific number of steps based on the number the previous player landed on. The game features an interactive UI for tracking turns, path highlighting, and dynamic square-blocking.
- **Recursive Pathfinding:** Engineered advanced game-state logic in Step Count (`canCompletePath`). This recursively looks ahead to check if a player is completely trapped or stuck, automatically handling game-over conditions and allowing players to gracefully reset their move.
- **Color Spiral Implementation:** Developed a single-player puzzle game where users rotate 2x2 tile blocks to form the largest contiguous color clusters. Successfully adapted the existing flood-fill algorithm to automatically calculate and update the score breakdown.
- **Daily & Unlimited Modes:** Implemented a dual-mode system for Color Spiral, featuring a date-seeded Daily Challenge with randomized move limits (6-20) ensuring global parity, alongside a freely playable, unseeded Unlimited Mode.

Scheduled tasks to be done by next report:

- **Navigation Integration:** Fully integrate Color Spiral and Step Count into the global navigation bar across all HTML files so the user flow remains seamless.
- **Final Polish Pass:** Conduct end-to-end bug testing across the entire suite of games, specifically focusing on edge cases in Step Count's movement cancellation logic and ensuring visual consistency.
- **Playtest and Revise Step Count:** Playing on my own revealed a potentially boring scenario where players are essentially stuck on their own islands. Looking into variations to make this game more interesting.

Current Status: ON TRACK. The platform has exceeded the original goal of three games and now features a robust lineup of unique titles. The remaining focus is exclusively on final cross-page navigation and overall platform polish.